PSE: AI, power and data-centre demand

Prepared for Padraig Smith, PSE. Private and confidential.

[V] public source, named below [H] hypothesis to test with you [C] to confirm with you. Nothing here is advice or an offer.

What is changing, and how fast

New AI models now arrive every few weeks, and each one changes what AI can do inside a business. Agents plan, use tools, connect to other systems and keep working for hours, acting on company data with real permissions. That asks for the same care around access, testing and oversight that a company gives its own people. Learning has to be continuous too.

What the last few months have shown

The same capability that makes AI useful is making attacks faster and cheaper. Examples as cited in Velocity AI's paper for another client (dated, sourced there; **Cuan has not independently verified them**): AI-assisted research found critical flaws in PHP, the software under most of the web, with a CISA alert on 21 October 2026; the UK National Cyber Security Centre warned on 3 November 2026 that AI now lets attackers strike before organisations have patched; and Chainalysis disclosed on 2 November 2026 that an outside actor used agentic techniques to reach its internal systems.

Three areas every business of this kind should have covered

- **AI capability and continuous learning:** the tools each role needs, owned and measured, with someone who keeps the team learning.
- **Defensibility, systems and resilience:** knowing which AI systems and agents are in use, what each can reach, and how the business keeps running if one fails.
- **Cybersecurity:** protecting networks, systems, supplier connections and connected equipment.

A new model lands at five o'clock, or something happens inside the business at five. What happens at 5:01?

Where PSE stands, from public sources

- [V] Enterprise Ireland's directory describes PSE as an energy technology solutions company offering backup and prime power generation (with a focus on natural gas generators), battery storage, and energy monitoring and management, for commercial and industrial customers and data centres [1].
- [V] Pramac announced a partnership with PSE on battery energy storage applications; its range is described as energy storage, UPS, standby generators and CHP [2]. Riello UPS named PSE Power a preferred partner in Ireland in September 2017, with Padraig Smith quoted [3]. [C] Whether that Riello arrangement is still current.
- [C] Base in Newcastle West, Co. Limerick, and headcount (profile sites give 44 to 63): confirm.

Part One: your ambition

[C] We have not recorded Padraig's own ambition for PSE. This section is left for what he tells us: where he wants PSE to be in two to three years, and what holds it back today.

Part Two: where AI and the market may help PSE, ranked by evidence

1. **The market is moving PSE's way.** [V] Ireland's Commission for Regulation of Utilities (CRU) ended the de facto moratorium on new data-centre grid connections. Under the new large energy users policy, data centres of 10 MVA and above must bring dispatchable onsite or proximate generation or storage matched to their import capacity, and participate in the electricity market; law-firm commentary says gas is the most likely fuel [4]. That is the demand PSE's products address. [C] How much enquiry PSE is seeing from it, and the final renewable-share rules, which sources describe differently and which should be read in the CRU decision itself.

2. **Quote and specification turnaround.** [H] An AI-assisted drafting step could turn an enquiry into a costed specification faster. Effort: medium. Test: take ten past quotes and time the current process against a drafted one. No evidence yet that this is a bottleneck for PSE.
3. **Regulatory and connection-process watch.** [V] The policy is live and system operators were due to publish a connection process in 2026 [4]. [H] A short weekly brief on CRU, grid operator and licensing changes, tailored to PSE's customers. Effort: low.
4. **Service reports from monitoring data.** [H] PSE sells energy monitoring [1]. If it holds equipment data, AI can turn it into plain customer reports and early-warning notes. Effort: medium; depends on data access and customer consent.
5. **Showing customers the 5:01 answer.** [H] Connected generators, batteries and monitoring are part of a customer's operational technology. Data-centre and industrial buyers increasingly ask suppliers how this is secured and governed. A short, clear supplier assurance pack could help win and keep work. Effort: low to medium.

Grant aid to check

- [V] Enterprise Ireland Digital Discovery or GrowDigital supports: sources describe up to 80% of costs, capped at about 5,000 euro, for expert help on a first step in AI or digital; amounts vary between sources [5]. [C] Eligibility and current terms with Enterprise Ireland.
- [V] The Local Enterprise Office Business Expansion Grant generally applies to businesses with 10 or fewer employees [6]. Profile sites suggest PSE is larger, so it probably does not apply. [C] Headcount.

Overall read

PSE sits in a market with a clear, policy-driven tailwind. The sharpest first step is not a big AI project. It is to find out which of the five ideas above solves a real bottleneck for PSE, starting with how its quotes and service reports are produced today.

Sources

1. Enterprise Ireland directory: PSE (https://directory.enterprise-ireland.com/vendor/construction-services/pse)
2. Pramac and PSE partnership (https://corporate.pramac.com/pramac-and-pse-forge-strategic-partnership-to-enhance-energy-solutions-in-ireland/)
3. TechCentral, Riello UPS names PSE Power as preferred partner in Ireland, Sept 2017 (https://www.techcentral.ie/riello-ups-names-pse-power-preferred-partner-ireland/)
4. Law-firm commentary on the CRU Large Energy Users connection policy: DLA Piper, Jan 2026 (https://www.dlapiper.com/en-us/insights/publications/2026/01/new-irish-large-energy-users-connection-policy); Arthur Cox (https://www.arthurcox.com/knowledge/new-connection-policy-for-data-centres-in-ireland/); A&L Goodbody (https://www.algoodbody.com/insights-publications/irelands-new-large-energy-users-leus-connection-policy-what-it-means-for-the-irish-energy-sector); Browne Jacobson (https://www.brownejacobson.com/insights/data-centres-in-ireland-the-cru-proposed-decision)
5. Enterprise Ireland Digital Discovery (https://www.enterprise-ireland.com/en/supports/access-advice-digital-discovery); Galvia AI and Digital Business Ireland coverage via search results
6. Local Enterprise Office Business Expansion Grant: Kerry LEO (https://www.localenterprise.ie/kerry/financial-supports/business-expansion-grant/); Carlow LEO 2026 form (https://consult.carlow.ie/en/content/local-enterprise-office-application-form-business-expansion-grant-update-2026)
7. Cyber examples as cited in Velocity AI paper "AI at UHL: the year ahead" (CISA alert 21 Oct 2026; Chainalysis disclosure 2 Nov 2026; NCSC Annual Review 3 Nov 2026); not independently verified by Cuan

Cuan read search summaries of these sources, not every page in full. Check figures with the owner before relying on them. Aggregator profiles (RocketReach, village.do) are low reliability and are used only as pointers.

FOR JOHN ONLY. REMOVE THIS PAGE BEFORE ANYTHING IS SHARED.

Approach. Padraig Smith is a different person from Pádraic Ó Máille (Shane's Sensai partner); keep the two apart. Check whether Padraig Smith knows Shane. Open as a conversation, with this brief as an aid, not a pitch. Nothing priced. Meridian is not incorporated, so no engagement through it.

Links to keep separate. PSE could be a supplier or partner for the Tairseach and Meridian data-centre thread (generation for large energy users). Do not mix a client approach with that. Raise it with Shane first.

Checks before use. Confirm Padraig Smith's role and the company name (PSE Power vs PSE Power (Cogeneration) Ltd, Station Road, Newcastle West, incorporated 18 Sept 2020; the link to PSE is unconfirmed). Verify the CRU decision details in the primary paper. Re-verify the three cyber examples. Shane's agreement on the Stage 1 lead-in wording.

Park rule. Two unanswered touches in 30 days means park for 90 days.